

Epstein files show he tried to squash alleged victim's blackmail attempt of New York elites



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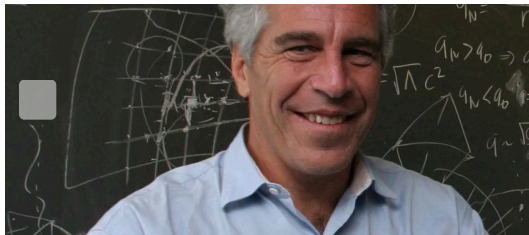
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(NewsNation) — Convicted pedophile [Jeffrey Epstein](#) sought help from a top Kremlin official within Russian President Vladimir Putin's inner circle to silence a woman who said she was trafficked by Harvey Weinstein and Leon Black in New York City, according to emails released by the Department of Justice last month.

In those documents, an email from July 24, 2015, showed [Epstein wrote to Sergey Belyakov](#), who was the deputy minister of economic development of Russia from 2012 to 2014, asking for a favor involving a Russian woman trying to blackmail "a group of powerful businessman in New York."



Billionaire Jeffrey Epstein in Cambridge, MA on 9/8/04. (Photo by Ri...



This undated photo released by the U.S. Department of Justice show...



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"It is bad for business for everyone involved. She arrived New York Saturday of last week staying at the Four Seasons. On 57 street. Suggestions?" Epstein wrote in the email.

Belyakov replied, asking for a few days to get information on the woman, documents show. The former Putin adviser responded several days later, saying he tried to make contact with the woman but didn't get a response, adding, "looks like business problems."

Epstein doc shows what Trump allegedly said after throwing him out of Mar-a-Lago

Belyakov listed her movements, noting that she "arranges business" in the U.S. and other locations. He stated she "has no patronage" and has been engaged in "numerous hard stories with no consequences for the other participants," the email in the documents stated.

Lastly, he stated denying her access to the U.S. would be "a real threat to her business."

Epstein victim attempted to blackmail Harvey Weinstein, Leon Black and Alan Dershowitz, emails claim

NewsNation has learned the woman was a primary informant to the FBI about Epstein's sex trafficking ring. She went to the FBI after she was allegedly trafficked to several of Epstein's friends, a member of Congress who has seen the relevant files unredacted told NewsNation.

The names appearing in these documents do not mean there is evidence of a [crime](#). No criminal charges against those named other than Ghislaine Maxwell were filed in connection with Epstein's crimes.



She assisted in preparing an [FBI PowerPoint presentation](#) examining a list of [high-profile men](#) with associations with Epstein. According to the documents, the list included President Donald Trump and former President Bill Clinton with a note, "Numerous anonymous NTOC's (National Threat Operations Center tips) were received with allegations against prominent individuals."

According to FBI documents, she told the bureau that as part of Epstein's operations, she was directed to give massages, was put in compromising positions and was a victim of sexual abuse.

She alleged Epstein trafficked her to Weinstein and Black at different times.

Among the allegations given to the FBI, the woman stated that Weinstein showed up at her door and tried to follow her into her shower after offering her a job.

Epstein files include mentions of prominent figures. Here's who was named

When asked about the claims in the FBI's memo against Weinstein, his attorney, Arthur Aidala, said, "No comment."

Weinstein is serving 23 years in a New York prison for [sexual assaults](#).



Harvey Weinstein appears for his retrial at a Manhattan court, Wednesday, May 21, 2025, in New York. (AP Photo/Pamela Smith, Pool)

Among allegations against Black given to the FBI, an alleged victim says Black raped and trafficked her multiple times and that he threatened her.

Black's attorney did not respond at the time of this piece's publication.

In a [statement to The Guardian](#), his attorney, Susan Estrich, wrote, "Mr Black asked for an independent investigation of his relationship with Epstein. The Dechert law firm investigated and reviewed more than 60,000 documents, interviewed more than 20 people and concluded that Mr Black paid Epstein for estate planning and tax advice and that he had no awareness of Epstein's criminal activities."

In the statement, Estrich also noted civil lawsuits against Black have been dismissed, withdrawn or are facing a case-terminating motion. She added, "There is absolutely no truth to any of the allegations against Mr. Black."

Ro Khanna reads redacted names from Epstein files on House floor

In the documents, the woman stated she gave Dershowitz, Epstein's former attorney, a massage on the disgraced financier's plane.

Dershowitz has denied any wrongdoing in connection with Epstein's sexual criminality.

"I never received a massage on Epstein's plane. I can prove that I was never on his plane with a young woman. She made up the entire story. In doing so she violated section 1001 of the criminal code—lying to the FBI," Dershowitz told NewsNation in a statement.

"She was not a minor. She is a criminal. There is no basis for redacting the name of an adult criminal. I'm planning to sue her as 'Jane Doe' and subpoenaing the justice department and FBI to reveal the name of this felon," Dershowitz also stated.



On NewsNation's "[CUOMO](#)," after files related to Virginia Giuffre's case were unsealed, Dershowitz stated that "the case against me has been totally demolished." Last fall, he said on "[CUOMO](#)" that he wanted all the evidence out with no redactions.

Majority of Epstein co-conspirators were women who were also trafficked: Source

A member of Congress who has seen the relevant files unredacted told NewsNation the majority of Epstein's co-conspirators for his minor female sex trafficking ring were women, many of whom were trafficked themselves initially and then began to recruit other females.

Epstein's former girlfriend and co-accomplice, [Maxwell](#), is the only co-conspirator to have been formally charged. She is serving a 20-year federal prison sentence.



FILE - Audrey Strauss, acting U.S. attorney for the Southern District ...



Jeffrey Epstein and Ghislaine Maxwell attend de Grisogono Sponsor...



American financier Jeffrey Epstein and British socialite Ghislaine...

Rachel Fischer, a forensic nurse expert and sexual assault nurse examiner specializing in anti-trafficking efforts, said in the trafficking sphere, a recruiter is referred to as a "bottom girl." Fischer says this is a "well-documented dynamic in organized sex trafficking operations" that is not a result of free choice and does not erase the victimhood from the survivors who became recruiters.

"Traffickers use isolation, psychological manipulation, threats, intermittent rewards, and dependency to create what we clinically describe as trauma bonds. Over time, victims are conditioned to comply in order to reduce violence, avoid punishment, or gain small protections," she said.

Fischer said the dynamic is common for some victims, usually framed as a way to make more money and get better treatment from the traffickers.

"In many cases, victims are told they will be harmed, replaced, or further exploited if they do not recruit. When someone is living under chronic coercion, their brain shifts into survival mode," she said.

When this happens, Fischer said it can blur a person's moral boundaries as exploitation becomes normalized. Abuse can create a distorted sense of power alignment with the traffickers, with victims feeling they may be safer the closer they get to the person in power.

"It is important to understand that this does not erase their victimization. It reflects the way coercive systems perpetuate themselves by forcing victims into roles that help sustain the exploitation structure. The transition from being trafficked to recruiting others is often an extension of the original abuse, not a departure from it," she said.

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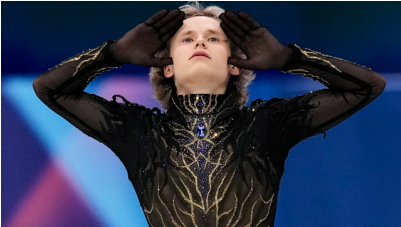
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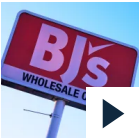
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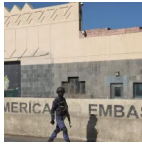
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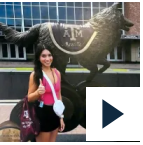
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